

PAKISTAN'S ROLE IN PROMOTING PEACE AND STABILITY IN SOUTH ASIA

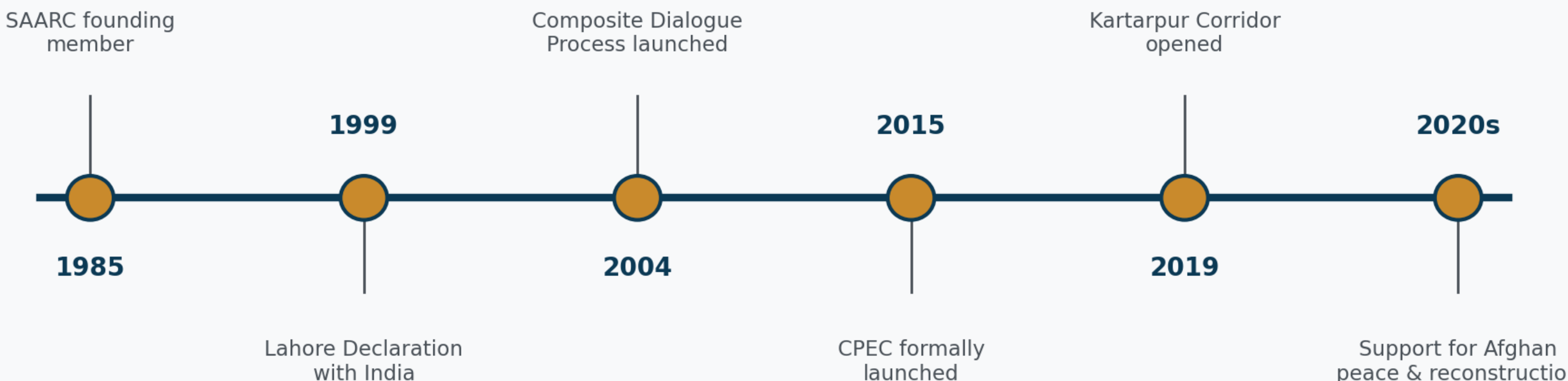
Diplomacy • Regional Cooperation • Conflict Prevention in a Complex Neighborhood

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KEY MILESTONES IN PAKISTAN'S REGIONAL PEACE DIPLOMACY

Timeline: Selected Pakistani Peace & Regional Stability Initiatives



Introduction

South Asia is home to nearly a quarter of humanity, yet remains among the least economically integrated regions on earth. Pakistan's geography — bordering India, Afghanistan, Iran, and close to China — places it at the center of the region's peace and security dynamics.

Objectives

- Examine Pakistan's diplomatic role in regional cooperation (SAARC)
- Assess Pakistan-India confidence-building efforts
- Evaluate Pakistan's contribution to Afghan stability
- Analyze CPEC as a tool of economic peace-building

South Asia's Geopolitical Landscape

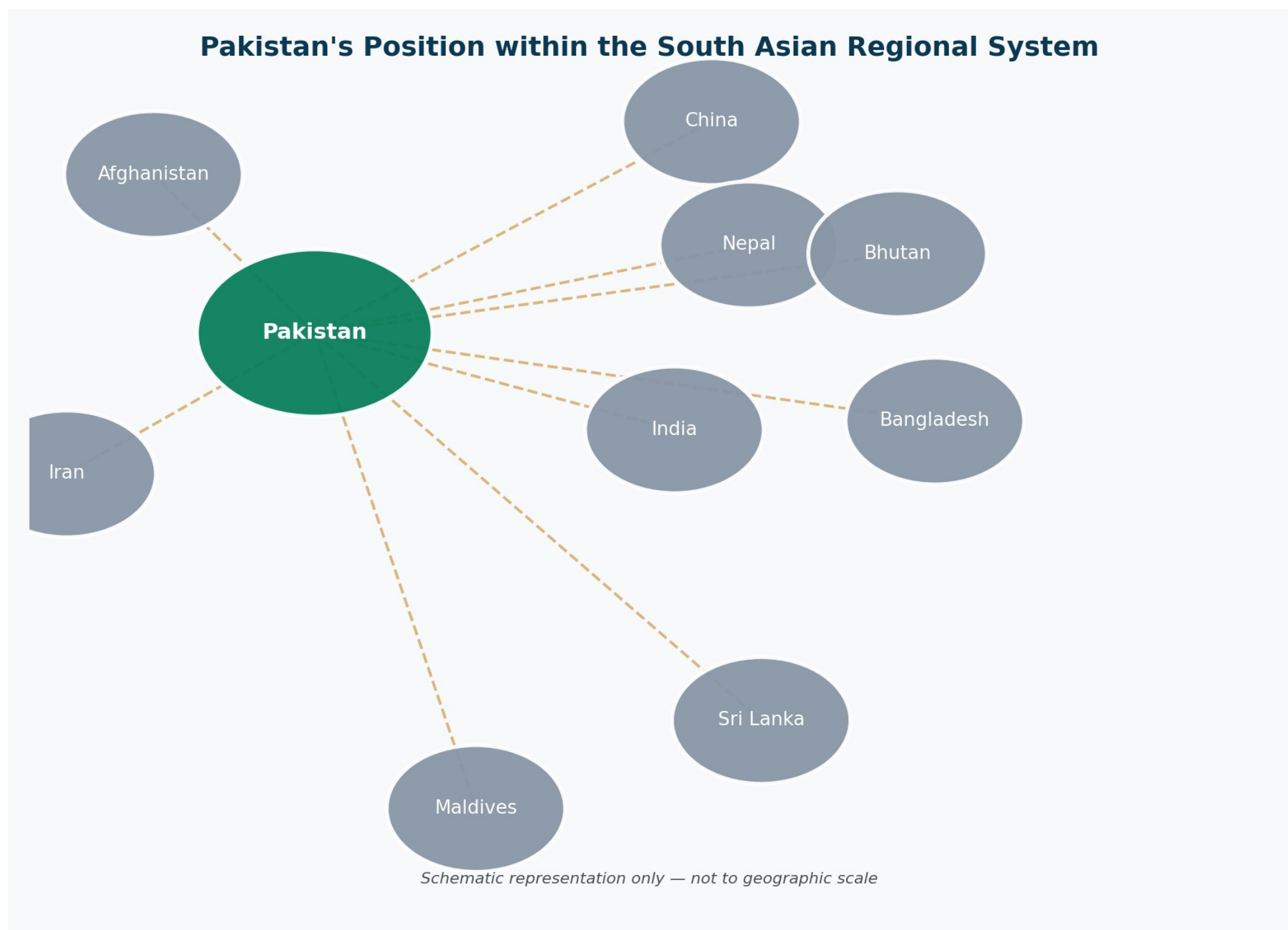


Fig. 1 — Pakistan's position within the South Asian regional system.

Pillars of Pakistan's Peace Policy

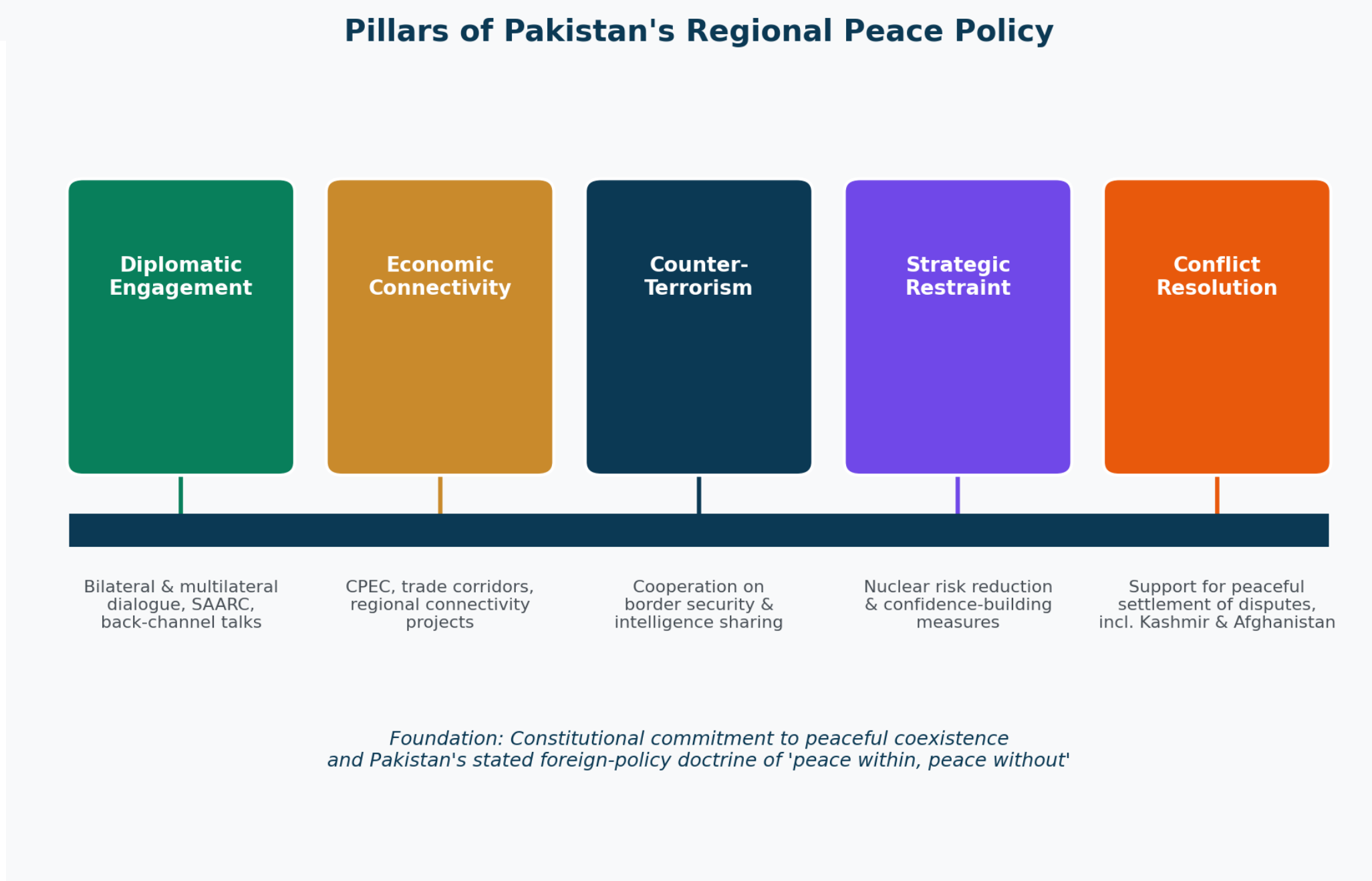


Fig. 2 — Interlocking pillars of Pakistan's stated regional peace policy.

Role in SAARC

As a founding member since 1985, Pakistan has consistently advocated for regional trade liberalization and connectivity through SAARC. However, persistent India-Pakistan tensions have structurally limited the platform's effectiveness for the wider region.

Pakistan-India Relations

Milestones such as the 1999 Lahore Declaration, the 2004 Composite Dialogue Process, and the 2019 Kartarpur Corridor reflect sustained — if uneven — efforts toward dialogue, confidence-building, and people-to-people diplomacy.

Afghanistan Peace Process

Pakistan has facilitated Afghan dialogue, hosted millions of refugees, and consistently supported an inclusive, Afghan-led political settlement — recognizing that instability there directly affects Pakistan's own security.

CPEC & Economic Connectivity

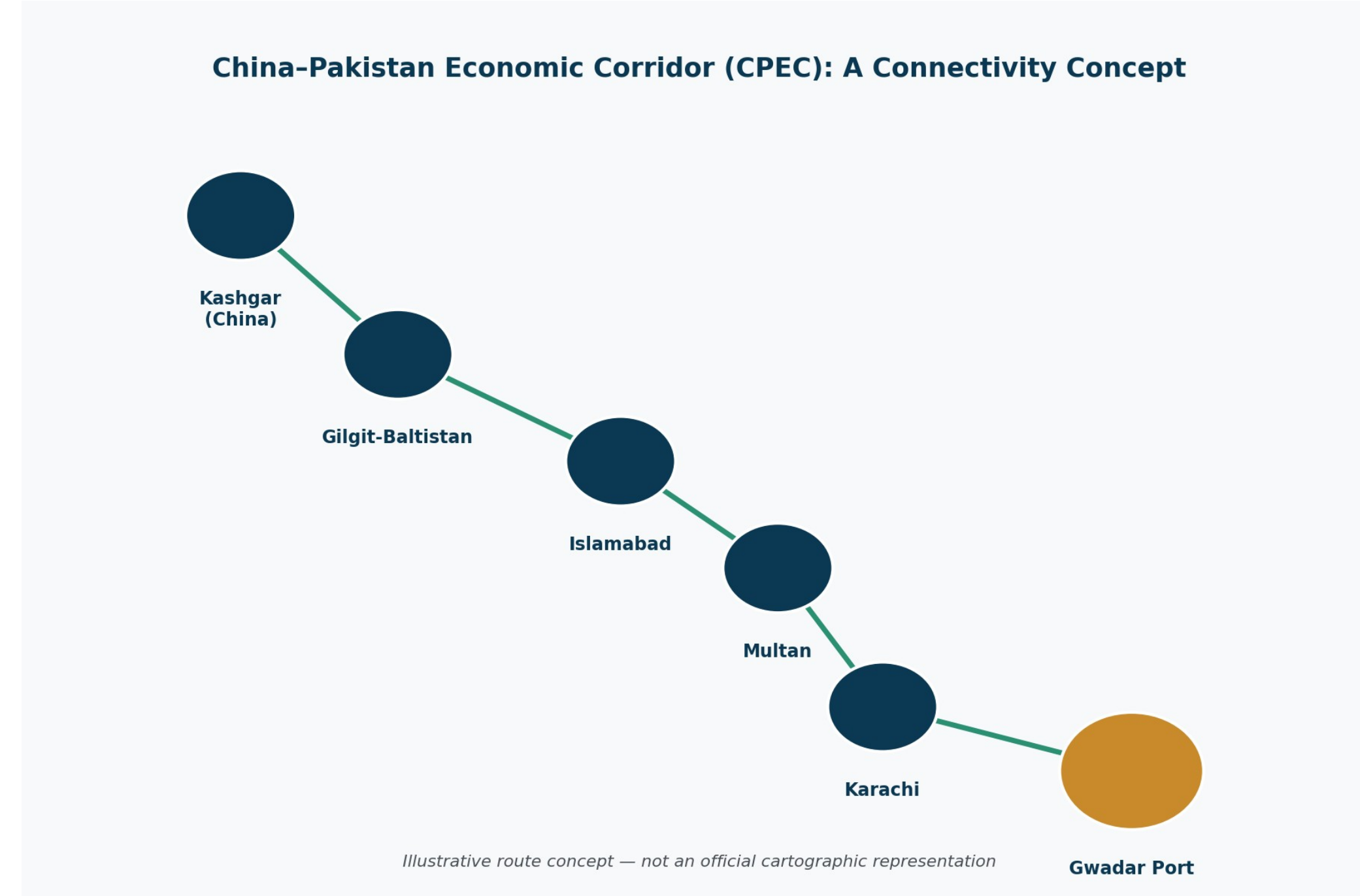


Fig. 3 — CPEC links western China to the Arabian Sea via Pakistan.

Key Challenges

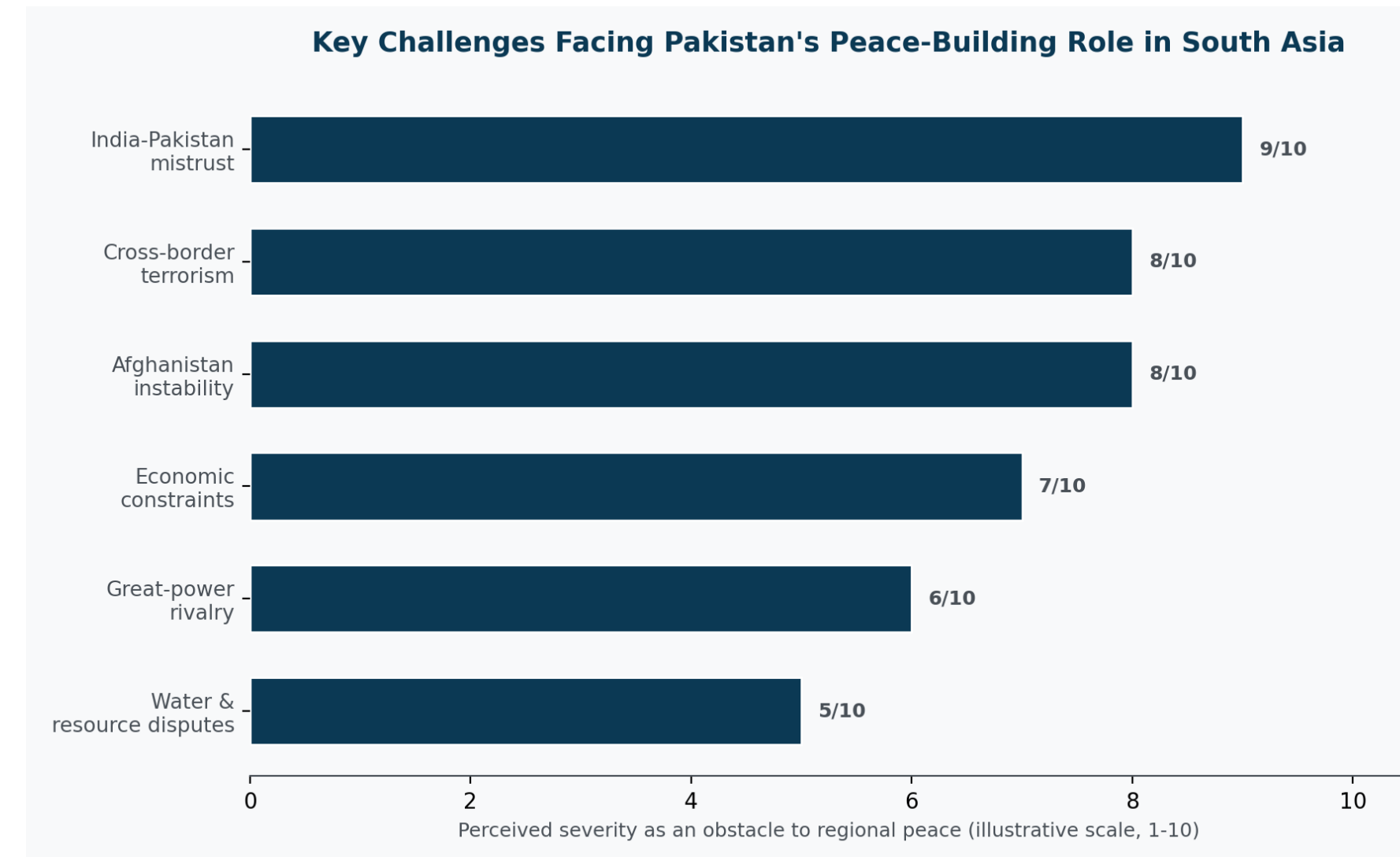


Fig. 4 — Obstacles constraining Pakistan's peace-building role.

Conclusion

Pakistan's founding role in SAARC, engagement with India, Afghan facilitation, and CPEC connectivity show peace framed as core national interest — though deep mistrust and structural constraints still limit its full potential.